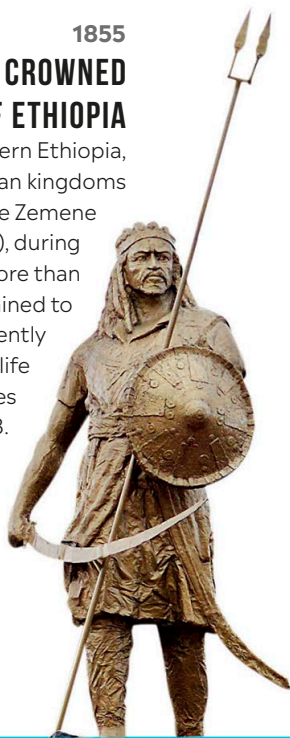


1855

TEWODROS II CROWNED EMPEROR OF ETHIOPIA

The architect of modern Ethiopia, Tewodros II, unified the Ethiopian kingdoms under his control, ending the Zemene Mesfint (Era of the Princes), during which the emperor was little more than a figurehead. He was determined to modernize the country but frequently faced opposition. He took his own life after the British attacked his forces at Maqdala in April 1868.

▷ Emperor Tewodros II



1855 David Livingstone is the first European to see the Mosi-oa-Tunya waterfalls on the Zambezi River; he renames them “Victoria Falls”

1855

“... scenes so lovely must have been
gazed upon by angels in their flight.”

DAVID LIVINGSTONE DESCRIBING THE MOSI-OA-TUNYA FALLS, 1855

▽ Plan of areas destroyed by the earthquake



1855

EDO EARTHQUAKE

The last of three powerful earthquakes to hit Japan in 1854-55, the Edo earthquake struck on 11 November. Its epicentre was near the mouth of the Arakawa River, close to Edo. Much of the city was destroyed by fire; more than 6,600 people died and a further 2,700 were injured. Woodcut prints depicting the earthquake quickly appeared, some showing Namazu, the giant catfish said to be the cause of earthquakes.